> operations. … It is important for the Island nation that there is no military conflict in the Indian Ocean.[28]

India has extended generous lines of credit to Bangladesh at approximately 1 percent interest and payable in 25 years. These credits are for a number of rail, bridge, infrastructure, and power, including nuclear power, projects. As noted earlier, their total value amounts to nearly $10 billion. The rate of utilisation of these loans has, however, been considerably slow due to technical, procedural, and bureaucratic hurdles on both sides.[29] Some, like the Maitree Super Thermal power project at Rampal, are also facing popular protests in Bangladesh on account of environmental issues. India has increased its power exports to Bangladesh, which now stand at 1170 MW. In return, Bangladesh has allowed hydro-power generated in India's Arunachal Pradesh to be transmitted to India's western region in Bihar through Bangladesh. To avoid the consequences of debt trap, and also in response to India's sensitivities, Bangladesh has declined Chinese assistance under BRI for the Padma Bridge and the development of a deep seaport in Sonadia.

India is not alone in being concerned about China's strategic push in Asia and in its immediate neighbourhood. Other major strategic players in Asia like the United States and Japan are also watching this development carefully and are keen to restrain Chinese expansion. These three countries interact with each other in trilateral (India–US–Japan) and quadrilateral (India–US–Japan and Australia) formats to ensure security and stability of the Indo-Pacific region that seem to be encroached upon by Chinese assertiveness. India is gradually joining hands with Japan and the United States to coordinate its efforts to meet the challenge of the Chinese economic and strategic push in the region.[30] Both the United States and Japan are equally interested in coming to India's support in this respect and